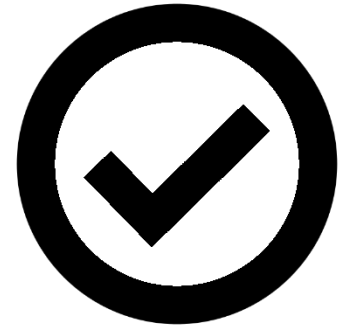




**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS**
of **AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



ECONOMIC RESEARCH TEAM

(160)

STATE 2021

Description

One economic research topic is selected by the National Center and provided at the beginning of the school year. The team will conduct research on the topic and present findings in a research paper, an oral presentation, and respond to questions from a panel of judges.

Topic

A balance of trade is the difference between the United States' exports and imports in a given year. This balance of trade can be a surplus or a deficit depending on the time and market. Both a surplus and a deficit are favorable and unfavorable simultaneously depending on who you ask. Research the recent history of the United States' balance of trade and discuss who the "winners" are and who the "losers" are. What, if anything, should be done to "correct" the balance of trade?

Teams who do *not* submit an entry that follows this topic will be *disqualified*.

JUDGING PROCEDURE

- As a team of judges, formulate two to three questions to ask at the conclusion of the presentation. Be sure to ask the same questions of each team.
- Teams will present before a panel of judges and timekeeper.
- The set-up time will be no more than three (3) minutes.
- The presentation will be no more than seven (7) minutes; followed by judges' questions not to exceed five (5) minutes.
- Excuse teams upon completion of judges' questions.
- **There can be no ties in the top ten (10) teams.** It is the responsibility of the judges to break any ties.
- Administrator will fill out ranking sheet prior to dismissing the judges.
- If more than one (1) section is necessary, finalists will be determined by selecting an equal number from each section.
- Give administrator all Judges' Rating Sheets, Judge Evaluation Sheets and contest materials.
- No audience is allowed in the contest room.

Sample Judge Questions

- How effective are our international trade agreements?
- What effect to tariffs have on this deficit/surplus?
- What are the arguments for and against free trade?
- How is the value of the dollar affected by the balance of trade?
- Explain how a deficit could be good or a surplus bad?

Please double-check and verify all scores!

Refer to [Style & Reference Manual](#) for MLA Report Style and Works Cited format.